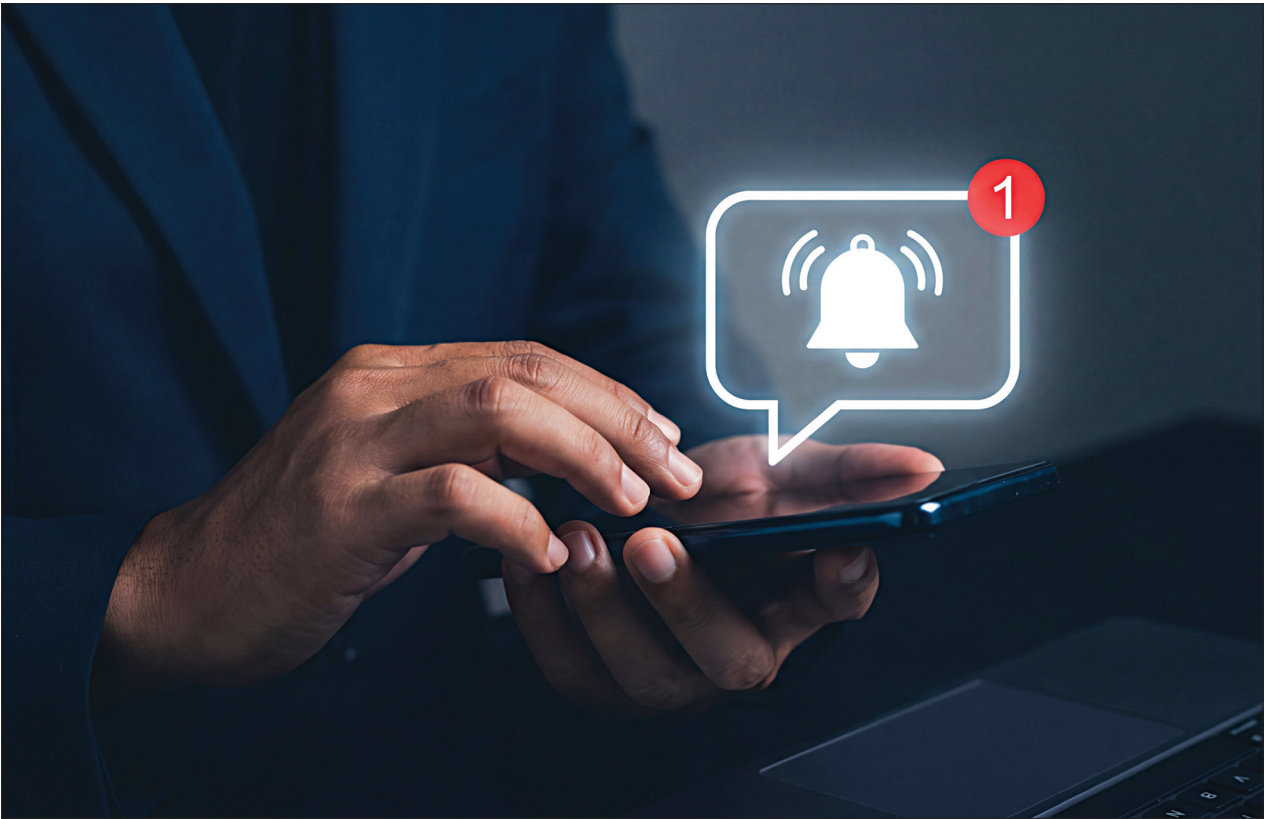




Notifications and focus

Make Android quieter without missing what matters

The modern Android phone does not merely ring. It nags, blinks, vibrates, bubbles, banners, pings, previews, recommends, reminds, warns, celebrates, tempts and occasionally screams. This is why mastering notifications is not a minor Android skill. It is survival.

The problem is not that notifications exist. The problem is that most phones are set up as if every notification is equally important. They are not. A low-balance banking alert matters. A cab arriving matters. A direct message from your child, parent, editor, manager or client matters. A flash sale for something you never intended to buy does not. A power user knows the difference and teaches the phone that difference.

Android gives you serious tools to do this: notification channels, notification history, lock-screen controls, Do Not Disturb, Bedtime Mode, Focus Mode, app timers and quick settings.

Google's Android help explains that users can control notifications by app, manage recent and last-24-hour alerts through notification history, and change how notifications appear. The goal is not to make the phone silent. The goal is to make it sane.

Notifications are not one thing

Most users think an app either has notifications on or off. Android is smarter than that. Many apps divide notifications into categories or channels. A shopping app may have order updates, delivery alerts, recommendations, promotions and account messages. A food app may have order status, coupons and marketing. A messaging app may have direct chats, groups, calls, backups and media notifications.

This matters because you may want some alerts from an app but not all of them. Turning off an entire food delivery app may